Python and Selenium Troubleshooting Guide

Acme Automation support notes | Version 1.5 | Updated: 25 October 2026

1. 'python is not recognized'

Likely cause: Python is not installed or its executable directory is not available on PATH. Check installation with the Windows app search, reopen the terminal after installation, and try the Python launcher command **py --version**.

2. 'No module named selenium'

Likely cause: Selenium is not installed in the Python environment currently running the script. Activate the intended .venv, check the selected VS Code interpreter, and install with **python -m pip install selenium**.

3. Browser opens and closes immediately

Likely cause: the script ends or an exception occurs before the test completes. Check the traceback, add appropriate waits, and ensure driver.quit() is placed in cleanup code rather than immediately after navigation.

4. ElementNotInteractableException

Likely cause: the element exists but is hidden, disabled, covered, or not ready for interaction. Wait for visibility or clickability, verify the locator, and check whether an overlay is covering the element.

5. NoSuchElementException

Likely cause: the locator does not match an element at the time of lookup, the page has not loaded the element, or the element is inside an iframe. Verify the locator, wait for presence, and switch to the correct iframe when required.

6. TimeoutException

Likely cause: the expected condition was not met before the wait expired. Confirm the page URL and locator, check network or application delays, and inspect whether the element is inside an iframe. The standard explicit wait is 10 seconds; increase it only when the application genuinely needs more time.

7. API returns 401

Likely cause: missing, invalid or expired bearer token. Confirm the Authorization header and obtain a fresh token. Remember that tokens expire after 60 minutes according to the API Reference.

8. API returns 429

Likely cause: more than 100 requests were sent per minute for one token. Stop sending requests and wait for the number of seconds specified by the Retry-After response header.

9. ChromeDriver or browser version problem

First update Chrome and retry with Selenium Manager. If the problem remains, record the Chrome version, Selenium version, operating system and full error message before escalating.

10. Escalation checklist

• Attach the full traceback or API response body.

- Record Python, Selenium and browser versions.
- State the command that was executed.
- Remove passwords, bearer tokens and personal data from logs before sharing.
- Include the expected result and the actual result.